

AETHER WIRELESS · KNOWLEDGE BASE

Roaming Policy

Category B — Policy & Process Knowledge Base

Document ID	AW-ROM-001
Version	1.3
Last Updated	July 2026
Department	Carrier Services
Company	Aether Wireless
Classification	Internal — Training & Reference

Overview

This policy establishes the roaming services available to Aether Wireless customers when traveling outside their home network coverage area. It defines the terms of domestic and international roaming, outlines fair-use guidelines, and specifies the notifications and features available while roaming. All roaming services are subject to network availability and partnership agreements. Customers should consult their specific plan details for eligibility and any applicable charges.

Domestic Roaming

Definition and Eligibility

Domestic roaming allows customers to use their Aether Wireless service on partner networks outside their home coverage area. This service is included at no additional charge for all Aether Wireless customers with compatible rate plans.

Domestic roaming applies to:

- Rural and remote areas where Aether Wireless does not maintain owned network infrastructure
- Locations where partnership agreements provide coverage access
- Temporary travel within the United States, including Alaska, Hawaii, and U.S. territories

Rural Partner Coverage

Aether Wireless maintains domestic partnership agreements with regional carriers to extend coverage to rural and underserved areas. Customers traveling in these regions receive full access to voice, text, and data services at no extra charge. Service quality may vary based on partner network capacity and infrastructure.

Fair-Use Policy and Data Deprioritization

When using domestic roaming on partner networks, a fair-use data cap applies:

- **Monthly Data Limit:** 50 GB per billing cycle
- **After 50 GB:** Data speeds may be reduced (deprioritized) during periods of network congestion

- **Deprioritization Priority:** Roaming data traffic receives lower priority compared to home network traffic and on-net partner traffic during peak usage periods

Customers who exceed the 50 GB fair-use cap will experience reduced data speeds until the next billing cycle begins or until network congestion subsides.

Usage Notifications

Aether Wireless provides proactive usage notifications to help customers track their roaming data consumption:

- **50% Notification:** Sent when 25 GB have been used
- **80% Notification:** Sent when 40 GB have been used
- **100% Notification:** Sent when 50 GB have been reached

Notifications are sent via SMS to the customer's registered mobile number.

International Roaming

Definition and Scope

International roaming permits customers to use Aether Wireless services while traveling outside the United States. This service extends to Canada and Mexico, with coverage availability varying by plan type.

Canada and Mexico Roaming

International roaming in Canada and Mexico is included on the following Aether Wireless plans:

Plan Type	Canada Roaming	Mexico Roaming
Premium	Included	Included
Family	Included	Included
Unlimited	Included	Included
Business	Included	Included
Basic	Not Included	Not Included
Prepaid	Not Included	Not Included

Customers on Basic or Prepaid plans may purchase international roaming add-ons separately. Rates and terms for add-on purchases are available through customer care.

International Data and Voice Services

When roaming internationally, customers receive:

- Voice calls (incoming and outgoing where supported)
- Text and multimedia messaging (SMS/MMS)
- Data services at international roaming rates or per add-on terms

International roaming rates vary by destination. Customers should contact customer care or visit the Aether Wireless website for current rates before traveling.

Network Selection and Connectivity

Automatic Network Selection

Aether Wireless devices are configured to automatically select the appropriate network when roaming. The device scans for available partner networks and connects based on the following priority:

1. Aether Wireless home network (preferred)
2. Domestic partner networks (roaming)
3. International partner networks (roaming)

Automatic network selection cannot be manually disabled. Customers who prefer to use only their home network may turn off roaming on their device, but this will result in no service when outside home coverage areas.

Wi-Fi Calling While Roaming

Wi-Fi calling remains available while customers are roaming domestically or internationally, provided:

- The device supports Wi-Fi calling
- A Wi-Fi connection is available and active
- Wi-Fi calling is enabled in device settings

Wi-Fi calling allows customers to make and receive calls and text messages over Wi-Fi when cellular signal is weak or unavailable. Standard calling rates apply based on the customer's plan and roaming status.

Emergency Calling

Emergency services are always accessible, regardless of roaming status:

- **911 (U.S.) and 112 (International):** Customers can dial emergency services from any connected network
- **Location information:** Emergency services may have limited ability to determine caller location when connected to a partner network
- **SIM card requirement:** A valid Aether Wireless SIM card must be present in the device

Customers should always attempt to provide their location information to emergency dispatchers when calling from a roaming network.

Deprioritization on Partner Networks

Crowded Network Conditions

When partner networks experience high traffic volumes, Aether Wireless customers roaming on those networks may experience reduced data speeds. This deprioritization occurs because:

- Partner networks prioritize their own customers and on-net traffic
- Roaming traffic receives best-effort service levels
- Network resources are allocated to manage congestion

Deprioritization affects all data activities including browsing, streaming, and application downloads. Voice and text services are generally not affected by network congestion.

Managing Expectations

Customers should expect:

- Slower data speeds during peak hours (typically evenings and weekends)
- Potential service degradation in high-traffic tourist or urban areas

- Variable performance based on partner network capacity

FAQs

Q: Can I turn off roaming on my phone to avoid charges?

A: Yes, you can disable roaming in your device settings. However, doing so will prevent you from using any cellular service (voice, text, or data) when outside your home network coverage area. You will have no service until roaming is re-enabled.

Q: What happens if I exceed my 50 GB domestic roaming data limit?

A: Once you exceed 50 GB, your data speeds will be reduced (deprioritized) for the remainder of the billing cycle. You will still have access to data, but speeds may be significantly slower during times of network congestion. Service restores to normal speeds at the start of your next billing cycle.

Q: Is international roaming included on my Basic plan?

A: No, international roaming in Canada and Mexico is not included on Basic plans. Only Premium, Family, Unlimited, and Business plans include Canada and Mexico roaming at no additional charge. Basic plan customers can purchase international roaming add-ons through customer care.

Q: How do I know when I've reached 50%, 80%, or 100% of my roaming data limit?

A: Aether Wireless sends SMS notifications at 50% (25 GB), 80% (40 GB), and 100% (50 GB) of your monthly roaming data usage. You can also monitor your usage through the Aether Wireless mobile app or by logging into your account online.

Q: Will Wi-Fi calling work while I'm roaming internationally?

A: Yes, Wi-Fi calling is available while roaming internationally if your device supports the feature and you have a Wi-Fi connection. Wi-Fi calling uses your existing Wi-Fi network to make and receive calls and texts, which can help avoid international roaming charges for voice services.

Q: Can I make emergency calls while roaming without a SIM card?

A: No, a valid Aether Wireless SIM card must be present in your device to access any network, including emergency services. While 911 and 112 calls can be made from partner networks, the SIM card is required for network authentication and connectivity.

For questions about roaming services, contact Aether Wireless Customer Care at 1-800-555-0199 or visit your local retail location.